

BECE 2021 QUESTIONS

NOVEMBER, 2021

ENGLISH LANGUAGE
Essay And Objective

1 Hour 45 Minutes

2&1

Name.....

Index Number.....

PB PAGEZ EXAMINATIONS

BASIC EDUCATION CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION (BECE)

ENGLISH LANGUAGE

PAST QUESTION

NOVEMBER, 2021

PART A

ESSAY WRITING

Your composition should be **250** words long

1. Write a letter to the Minister of Transport suggesting **two** ways of improving the public transport road system in the country.
2. As the main speaker in a debate on the motion, Students should **not wear** uniform to school, write your speech **for** or **against** the motion.
3. Write a letter to invite your cousin to spend the holidays with your grandparents, giving two reasons why he/she should pay them a visit.

PART B

COMPREHENSION

[30 MARKS]

4. *Read the following passage carefully and answer **all** the questions that follows.*

The tiger, the cheetah and the cat belong to the same family. The tiger is the largest member of the family. Although it is a wild animal, it is sometimes trained to assist acrobatic in entertaining people. The cheetah is the fastest animal on land. It can be trained to hunt other animals. Cats are found in many homes but there are wild ones too.

Although cats are found in many homes, man did not intentionally domesticate them. Before man learnt to grow crops and rear animals, he used to depend on plants and animals in the bush for food. When he gathered grains, which were seeds of grass, he accidentally took away the food of the rodents such as mice and rats. These followed their foods indoors. The wild cat, the natural enemy of the rats and mice, also followed the domestic granaries.

Cats did not eat the grains that were that were becoming the main source of nourishment for man. Therefore, they were encouraged to remain at home in order to get rid of the rodents. Man, also probably found out that cats were neater and quieter than dogs.

When ships were invented and man began to trade farther, grains were very important commodities. They were used not only as provisions but as items of barter. The mice and the rats went along, once again followed by the cats. In this way, a food chain that began in grasslands to the south and east Mediterranean Sea has spread to all corners of the world.

- (a) (i) What two types of cats are mentioned in the passage?
(ii) How did the cat become a domestic animal?
- (b) For what two reasons did man prefer cats to dogs?
- (c) What human activity led to the spread of cats to all corners of the world?
- (d) (i) ... a food chain. What is referred to as a *food chain* in the passage?
(ii) Why do you think grains were easily transported to all corners of the world?
- (e) Explain, in your own words, the following expressions as used the passage:
 - (i) The domestic granaries;

- (ii) Items of barter;
 - (iii) All corners of the world;
- (f) For each of the following words, give another word or a phrase that means **the same** and can fit into the passage:
- (i) Sometimes;
 - (ii) Intentionally;
 - (iii) Gathered;
 - (iv) Nourishment;
 - (v) Probably;

PART C
LITERATURE
[10 MARKS]

SACKEY J.A. and DARMANI L. (COMP): The cockcrow

5. Questions 5(a) to 5(c) are based on the abridged and simplified version of Charles Dickens' *Oliver Twist*.

CHARLES DICKENS: *Oliver Twist*

‘Mr Bumble made Oliver miserable and the boy couldn’t wait to get away from the workhouse.’

- (a) Mr. Bumble made Oliver miserable because
- (b) Who is Mr. Bumble?
- (c) How did Mr bumble try to get rid of Oliver?

Read the following extract carefully and answer Questions 5(d) and 5(e).

KEN SARO-WIWA: *Home Sweet Home*

“They came in the usual assortment of rags: gowns picked up from the stores of second-hand clothes traders, singlets bearing the words, *Oxford University*, mildewed blouses. Some women wore shirts that are meant for men; one of them was in a printed cotton nightgown that had fade beyond recognition.”

- (d) *They* refers to
- (e) An imagery of is created in the extract.

Read the following extract carefully and answer Questions 5(f) and 5(h).

AMA ATA AIDOO: *The Dilemma of a Ghost*

EULALIE: Ya, I remember I bought the idea, but I got the feeling ...

ATO: Heavens, women! They are always getting feelings. First, you got the feeling you needed a couple of years to settle down and now you are obviously getting a feeling.

- (f) What idea did Eulalie buy?
- (g) What feeling has she got now?
- (h) How does Ato react to her feelings?

Read the following extract carefully and answer Questions 5(I) and 5(J)

V.B. AAKYE: The colour of God

How silly man is, laughs the rose
Why should he be black or white
Or green or yellow or even red?

- (i) The literary device used in *laughs the rose* is
- (j) According to the poem, what is the colour of God?

END OF ESSAY TEST

PART A
LEXIS AND STRUCTURE

SECTION A

*From the alternatives lettered A to D, choose the one which **most suitably completes** each sentence.*

- | | |
|--|---|
| <p>1. Can I borrow your Hat?
A. Blue new straw
B. New blue straw
C. New straw blue
D. Straw new blue</p> <p>2. She will not give us more money.
A. Any
B. Even
C. Much
D. little</p> <p>3. You would be hungry if you to eat.
A. Are refusing
B. Refuse
C. Refused
D. Were refusing</p> <p>4. You have seen them, you?
A. Did
B. Didn't
C. Had
D. Haven't</p> <p>5. Habib goes to school train.
A. By
B. In
C. On
D. with</p> <p>6. She does not like letters.
A. To be writing
B. To write
C. Write
D. writing</p> <p>7. You will be ill if you raw meat.
A. Ate
B. Eat
C. Had eaten
D. Have eaten</p> <p>8. It was done according the rules.
A. By
B. Of
C. To</p> | <p style="text-align: right;">D. with</p> <p>9. the challenges, we succeeded.
A. As such
B. However
C. In spite of
D. Nevertheless</p> <p>10. My brother, with his wife and children,
..... Travelling to salaga next weekend
A. Are
B. Is
C. Was
D. Were</p> <p>11. It is high time we the journey.
A. Are starting
B. Shall start
C. Start
D. started</p> <p>12. I prefer oranges mangoes.
A. On
B. Than
C. To
D. for</p> <p>13. His aunt spoke to us lives in
Tamale
A. That
B. Which
C. Who
D. whom</p> <p>14. Araba couldn't resist tasting the food while
on fire.
A. By opening
B. Open
C. To open
D. opening</p> <p>15. My neighbour, dog barks every
night, has left town.
A. Which
B. Who
C. Who's</p> |
|--|---|

D. Whose

SECTION B

Choose from the alternatives lettered A to D the one which is **nearest in meaning** to the word in **each** sentence.

16. The chosen poems are very relatable
A. Preferred
B. Selected
C. Prescribed
D. given
17. Arming the police does not halt crime.
A. Avoid
B. Prevent
C. Stop
D. suspend
18. All the lax rules have been cancelled.
A. Mild
B. Previous

- C. Weak
D. wrong
19. The youth should be ruled by the fundamental ideals of courtesy.
A. Essential
B. Known
C. Popular
D. realistic
20. The porter could not endure his insults
A. Accept
B. Agree
C. Approve
D. Bear

SECTION C

In **each** of the following sentences a group of words has been underlined. Choose from the alternatives lettered A to D the one that **best explains** the underlined group of words.

21. Azara burnt her fingers when she took sides with her friend. This means that Azara
A. Got herself into trouble
B. Hated her friend
C. Showed how brave she was
D. Supported her friend
22. A desperate man may clutch at straws to save himself. This means that he may
A. Decide to act bravely
B. Seize any opportunity
C. Try all clever means
D. Use a secret strategy
23. Gil held her tongue on sensitive political issues. This means that she
A. Bit her tongue

- B. Kept silent
C. Maintained her stand
D. Refused to laugh
24. The project is in the pipeline. This means that it is
A. Being dealt with
B. Being suspended
C. No longer pursued
D. Stuck in the pipe
25. Ammon has always kept his enemies at arm's length. This means that he
A. Abused them
B. Shunned them
C. Threatened them
D. Trusted them

SECTION D

From the list of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is **most nearly opposite in meaning** to the underlined in **each** sentence.

26. That shop has been temporarily closed down.

- A. Constantly
- B. Deliberately
- C. Legally
- D. permanently

27. He normally alights at the station

- A. Ascends
- B. Boards
- C. Enters
- D. joins

28. Abeiku feels unsafe in his house

- A. Afraid
- B. Rejected

C. Secure

D. unhappy

29. The audience laughed at his funny stories.

- A. Cheerful
- B. Humourless
- C. Familiar
- D. peculiar

30. The prefect rebuked the student for his rude behaviour

- A. Defended
- B. Justified
- C. Pardoned
- D. Praised

END OF PAPER